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12.3 J-1 Student Employment

Focus Questions:

- *Can J-1 students take jobs that are not related to their field of study?*
- *Who would have to approve a J-1 student's off-campus work due to extraordinary circumstances?*

J-1 students must have received authorization from their J-1 program sponsor to apply for/work in all types of employment.

Options for J-1 student employment fall into three categories:

1. *On-campus*: On-campus jobs can be related or unrelated to the student's field of study. The school does not have to be the employer. For example: exchange visitors work for a commercial company, such as a food service, operating on the campus.
2. *Academic Training*: Academic training is authorized employment related to a student's field of study. It is intended to provide hands-on, practical experience complementary to the academic degree. J-1 students are eligible for up to 18 months of practical training upon completion of their degree (three years for post-doctoral training). The student **MUST** have a job offer related to his/her field of study to request academic training.
3. *Off-campus*: Exchange visitors may be authorized for off-campus employment when necessary due to "serious, urgent and unforeseen economic circumstances" that have arisen since the exchange visitor's sponsorship on the J-1 visa. Such employment will be authorized in writing by a Responsible Officer (RO) or Alternate Responsible Officer (ARO) indicating the name and address of the employer and the dates of employment.

Students interested in working should contact their DSO for international students. For more information, visit the DHS “Study in the States” [website](#).

To keep up with current visa regulations, consult the [USCIS website](#).

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